

find out about the extra fees until you're signing the papers to close the deal. Even though lenders are required to give you an estimate of fees in advance, they often tack on these additional charges at the last minute. If that happens, all you can do is try to negotiate a better deal (you may be surprised at how successful this can be). This will, however, be less of an issue in 2010 when new regulations issued by the Department of Housing and Urban Development (HUD) go into effect. Lenders will have to fill out a standard form, a Good Faith Estimate, with a detailed estimate of your costs. They will then have to show you a direct comparison at the closing of estimated costs and actual final costs, which are not to be more than 10% higher.

FIGURE 7-2	
PAPERWORK YOU WILL NEED IN ORDER TO APPLY FOR MORTGAGE PREAPPROVAL	
GENERAL INFORMATION	
Name and co-borrowers' names	Number of children
Age	Address
Marital status	Telephone number
Social Security number	Residence history
Landlord info	(last two years)
INCOME	
Employer's name and address	Bonuses
Job title	Average overtime or commissions
Date hired	Employment history
Federal tax information	(last two years)
Salary	
ASSETS	
<i>Total sums in:</i>	
Bank (including savings, checking, money market accounts)	Other investments, including real estate
CDs	Retirement accounts
Mutual funds	Cash-value life insurance
Stocks	Automobile, including year bought and current value
Bonds	Gifts expected from friends or relatives
DEBTS AND EXPENSES	
<i>Current balances and monthly payments on:</i>	
Credit cards	Car loans
Student loans	Other loans
Rent	